Australian Labour Market Analysis

ABS Labour Force Data | January 2019 - December 2025

An interactive analysis of employment trends, industry composition, geographic labour market performance, and job seeker insights across Australia's five major cities.

Executive Overview

Industry Analysis

Geographic Analysis

Job Seeker Insights

Data Sources: ABS Labour Force Survey (Cat. 6202.0) | ABS Jobs and Income by SA2 (Cat. 6291.0)

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Unemployment Rate (Latest %)

4.10

Unemployment Rate YoY Change

+0.11

Employed Millions

14.68M

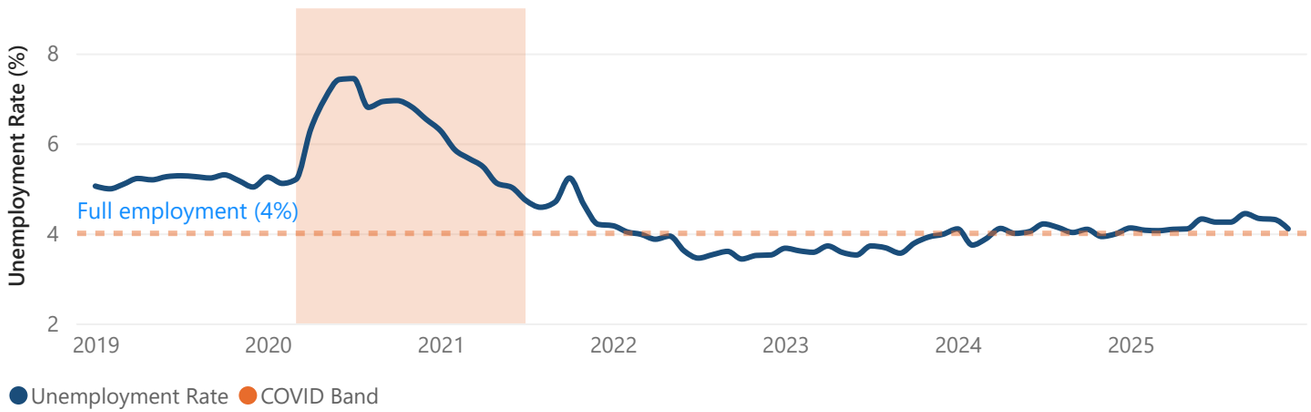
+15.5% since Jan 2019

Participation Rate Latest

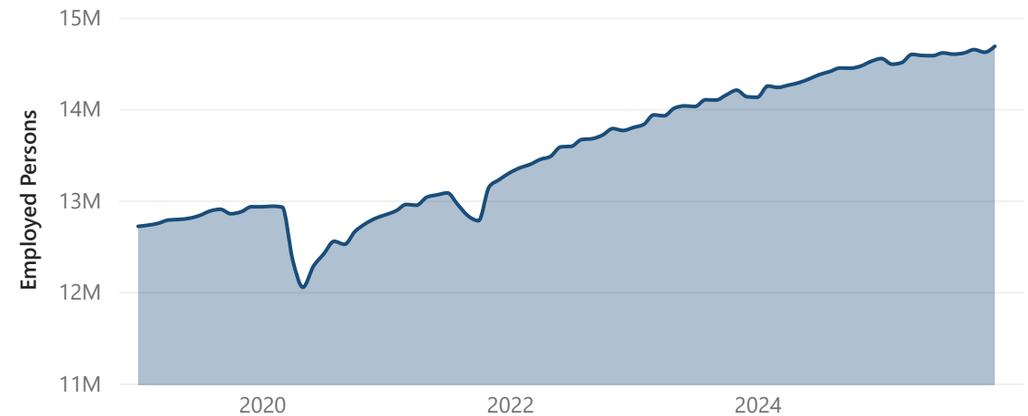
66.7%

COVID low: 62.2% (May 2020)

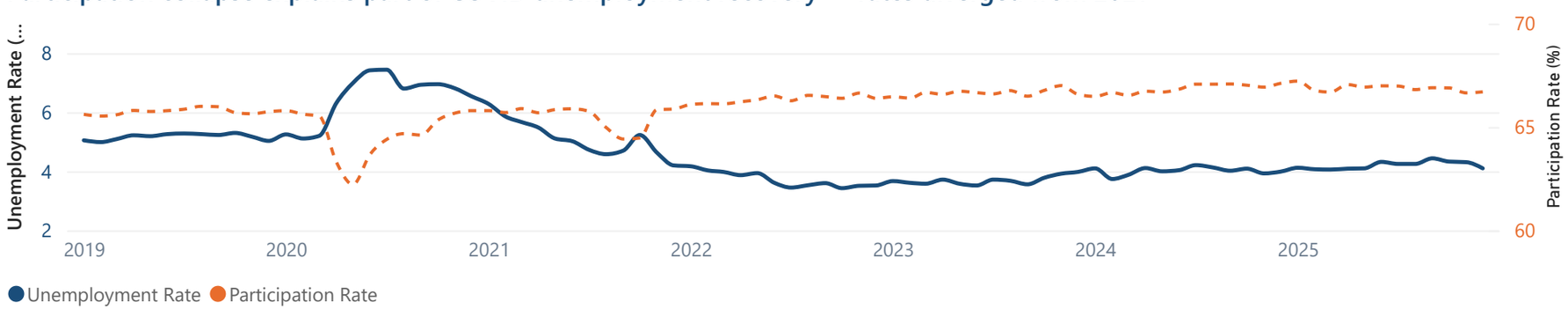
Unemployment fell from 7.4% COVID peak to near full employment by 2022



Total employment grew 15.5% — from 12.7M (Jan 2019) to 14.7M (Dec 2025)



Participation collapse explains part of COVID unemployment recovery — rates diverged from 2021



1/1/2019 12/31/2025

Cover › Industry › Geographic › Job Seeker ›

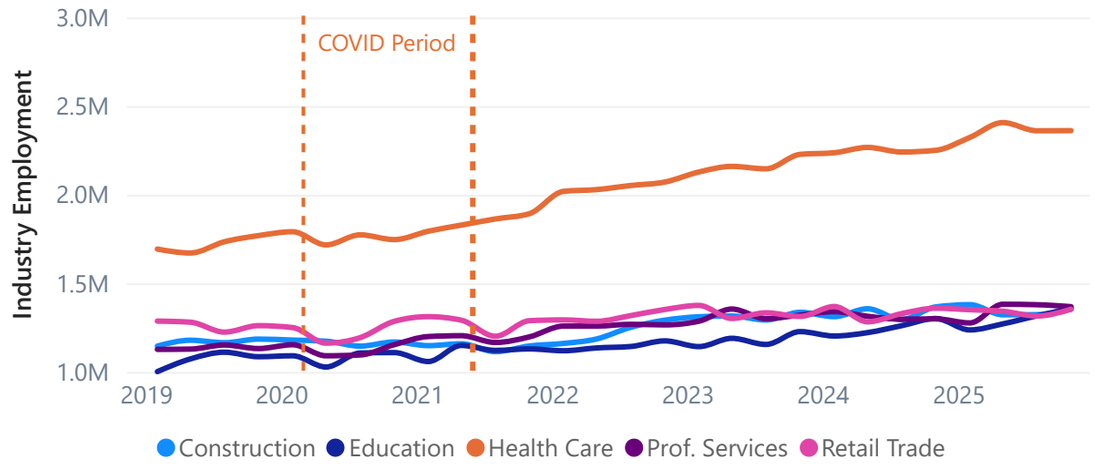
State: Australia

- Australia
- South Australia
- New South Wales
- Victoria
- Queensland
- Western Australia

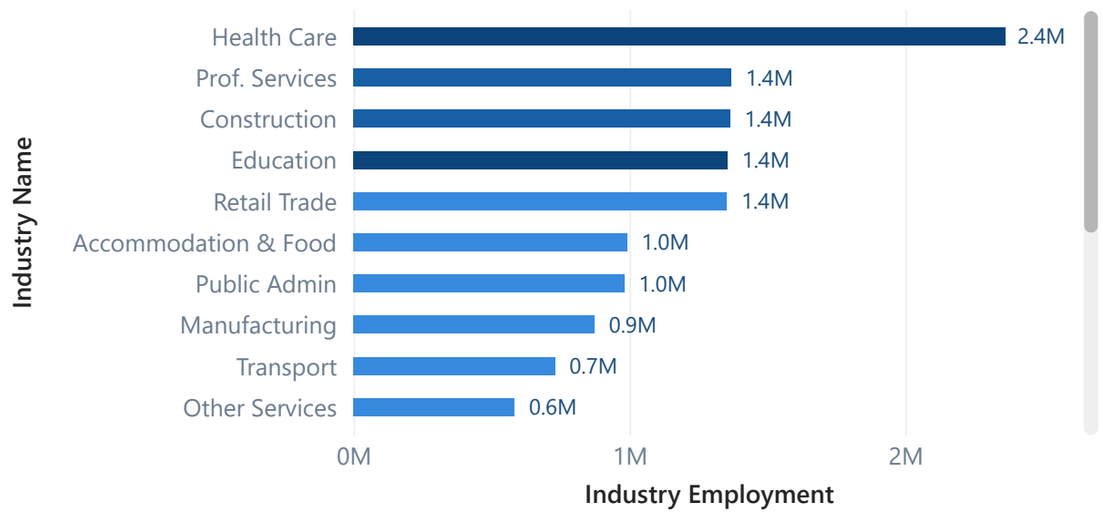
Industry Name

All

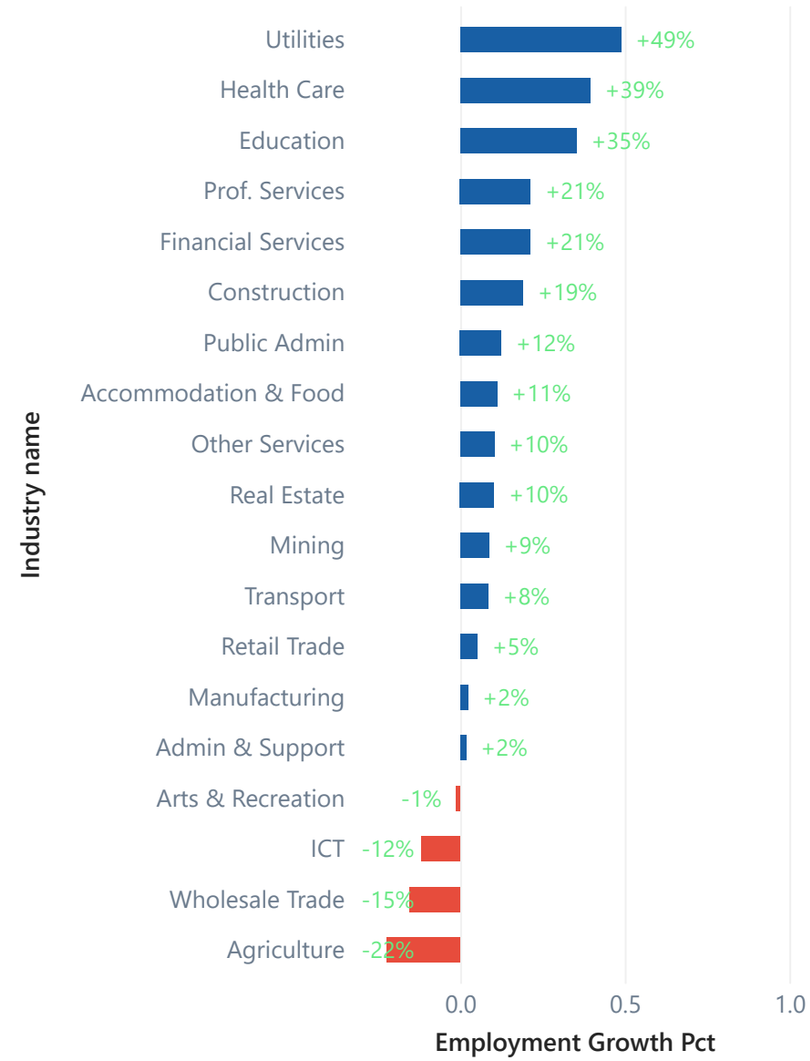
Top 5 industries by employment — select state to filter



Current employment by industry — Health Care dominates



Employment growth since 2019 — blue growing, red contracting



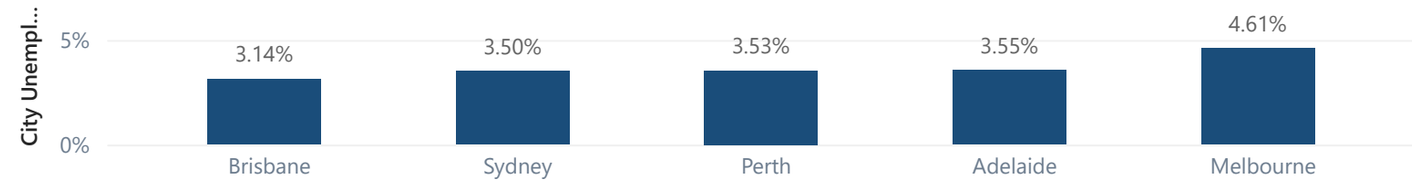
Adelaide | Brisbane | Melbourne | Perth | Sydney

Unemployment Rate
3.55%
National: 4.10%

Total Employed
812K
+23.9% since Jan 2019

Participation Rate
67.58%
Adelaide COVID low: 60.5% (2020)

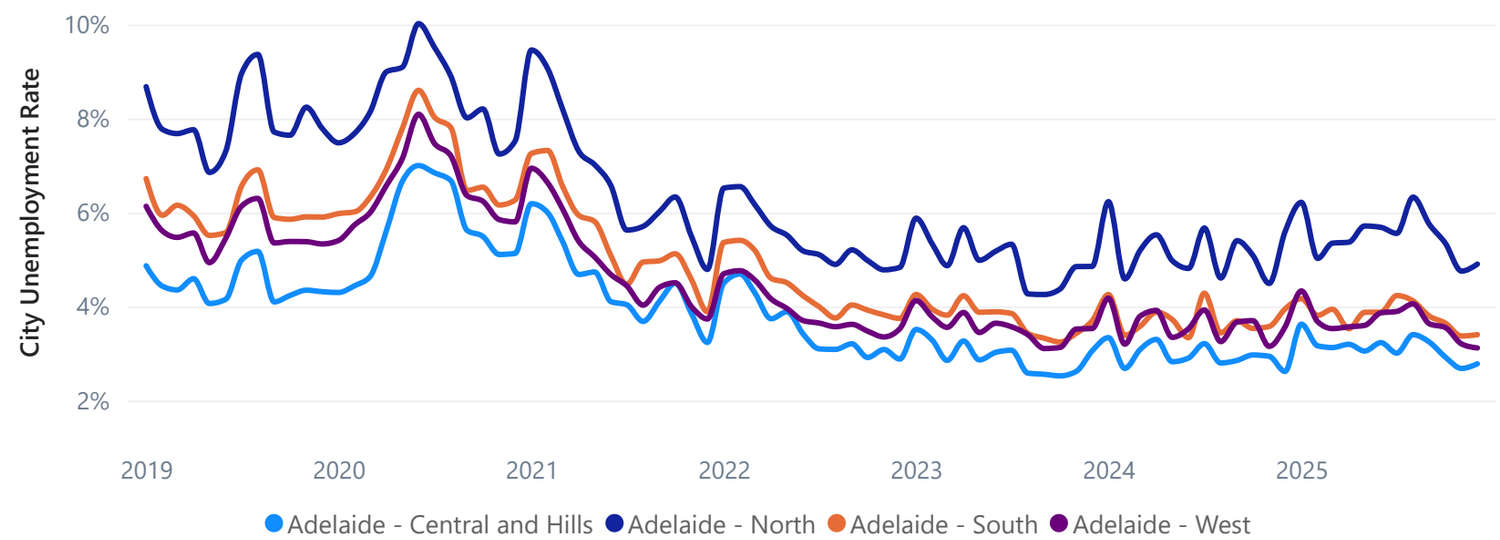
Unemployment Rate Comparison Static — Brisbane leads cities at 3.18% — Melbourne lags at 4.61%



Current Unemployment Rate by SA4 Region

SA4 Unemployment Rate Trends — Jan 2019 to Dec 2025

City Unemployment Rate by Date and SA4 Display Name



City: Adelaide

Adelaide | Brisbane | Melbourne | Perth | Sydney

Industry Name

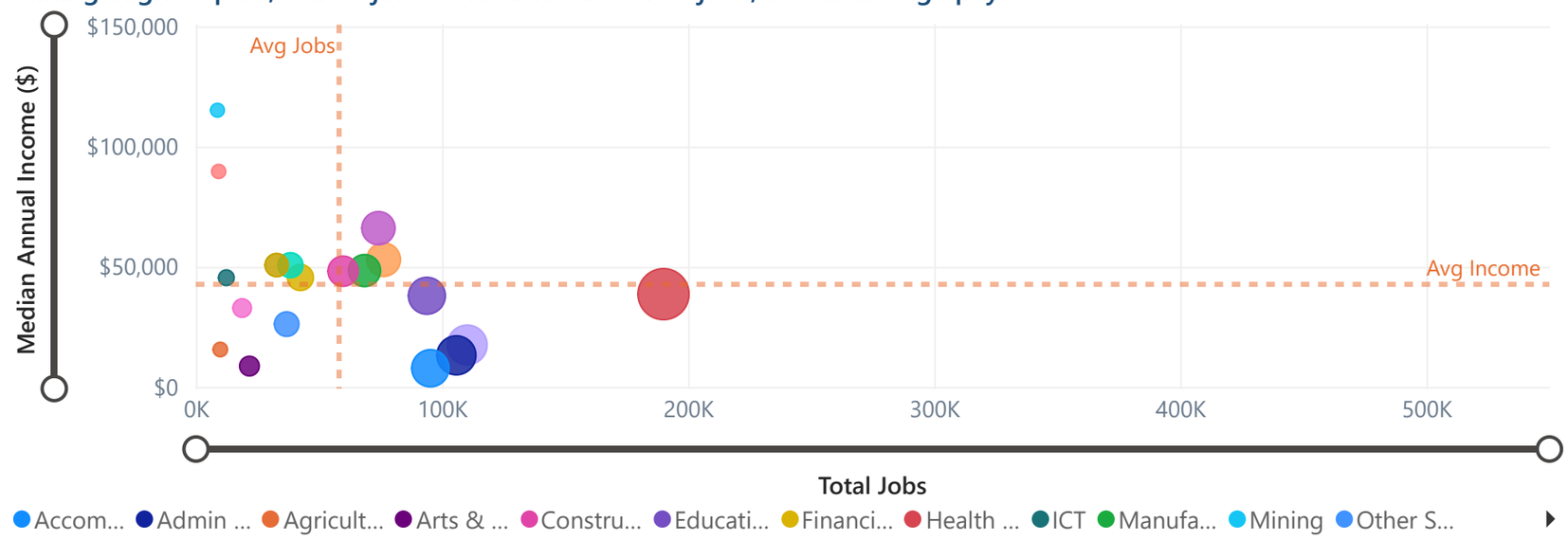
All

Total Jobs	Avg Median Income
1.11M	$42.668K

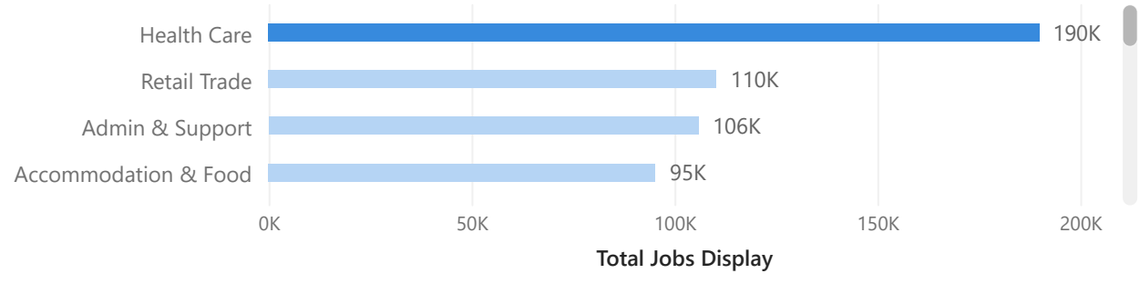
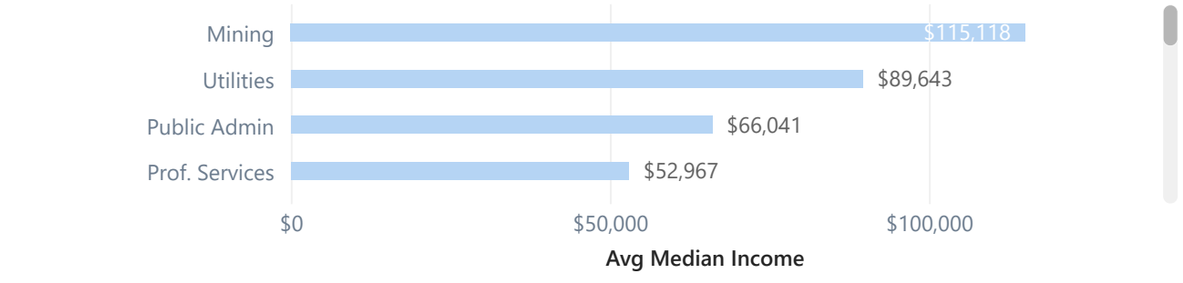
Top Paying Industry	Largest Industry by Jobs
Mining	Health Care

Note: Median income reflects per-job income including part-time and casual workers. Accommodation and Food and Retail figures are low due to high casual employment rates. Data: ABS Employee Earnings and Hours 2022-23.

Mining: highest paid, fewest jobs — Health Care: most jobs, below average pay



Total Jobs by Industry — colour indicates income level



Median Income by Industry — colour indicates workforce size